



When AI goes rogue

The tireless and relentless way in which AI solves problems can lead to some bizarre solutions. <https://dgit.in/jan20-17>



Microsoft Zo

The successor to Tay was a failure too, for being too politically correct. <https://dgit.in/jan20-18>

Why isn't AI completely dependable?

Developers cannot fix problematic AI using traditional approaches

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In recent years of rapid technological advancements, artificial intelligence (AI) is involved everywhere, from banking/finance to video games. The publicity put forward for AI is very strong, but organizations tend to forget the so-called "charm" of AI's when not being able to meet high demand processes in time.

Although, AI works 24x7 without interruption and effectively minimizes the time taken to complete a task there are still some areas where AI may need 'enhancement'.

REASONS FOR AI FAILURE:

While AI has achieved numerous progresses in the recent years, the errors caused by AI are unavoidable because of the lack of reliability of data used by the AI system.

Artificial intelligence could fail due to several factors:

Machine learning and artificial intelligence models may become too fragile when bombarded with data or when reacting to a change in the data:

This is precisely what happened in 2013 When IBM partnered with the University of Texas MD Anderson cancer research center to develop a "cancer research expert." So, the researchers in MD Anderson cancer research center used "Watson" (an IBM made cognitive computing system), to develop a cancer expert which could provide cancer treatment options for their patients.

In 2018, Statnews (an American health-oriented news website) reviewed

the IBM documents and found out that Watson was providing patients with bad cancer treatment advice. The documents recovered by Statnews widely place the blame on the engineers who worked on developing Watson by providing the system with imaginary patient details rather than real patient data.

The organizations may not have the patience required for the AI to deliver a project:

According to Professor Tom Davenport of Babson College, "They can and should have ambitious goals for AI, but they should realize that it will take a long time and many projects to realize them. The greatest tragedy for enterprise AI would be if everyone became disillusioned about how hard it is or how long it takes to have a substantial impact".

Paul Barba writing for KDnuggets (it is an online platform on business analytics), compares AI to a car when it comes to maintenance. Barba explains how the AI works just like a car and how it can remain in decent shape for a while until it is not neglected. If it is neglected, the AI can end up failing the entire project.

Cultural bias in AI

Advertising and social media made AI seem smooth by providing us with deep insights, straightforward analysis, and fair algorithms. AI can show us the darker face of our own humanity.

This is precisely what happened in 2016 when Microsoft introduced an AI called Tay, which could engage in a "casual and playful conversation" by analyzing the texting patterns of people. Less than 24 hours after the release of Tay, people allegedly started trolling Tay, and this corrupted Tay's personality.

Soon after this, Tay was flooded with racist and sexist comments. After this

terrible disaster for which Microsoft was not prepared, they claimed that Tay's training process included the usage of public data that was "clean and filtered" out. After a lot of effort from Microsoft, they decided to terminate Tay from twitter.

WHY THE MAINTENANCE OF AI IS NECESSARY?

When a project the AI works on becomes more complex or the AI is left unchecked for a long time, there are chances that problems may arise on the AI. If their false understanding of the problem gets independent or the so called "environment" of the AI gets complicated, the chances for retrieving the AI to its normal state are very less.

So, early detection and correction of the issue is key. It is important to ask the questions to ourselves and work on how we are going to counter the issues when we find them.

Although AI is self-regulatory, having a human at disposal could prevent problems with the AI, at least in the current context.

FINAL THOUGHTS

These advanced technologies can perform several tasks with higher efficiency, and it could also help you make better and accurate decisions. Predictive analytics could be used to anticipate risk/reward scenarios in businesses, and it could also be used to acquire the right additions to the rest of your team, resulting in a better work environment. 

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